"The Greatest Expedition you will ever undertake is the journey to self-understanding, for the real voyage of discovery consists not in seeking new lands, but in seeing with new eyes."

DANIEL J COMP

AN INTERACTIVE - AI GUIDED - SELF-MASTERY EXPEDITION FOR LEAVING

SCOTOMAVILLE



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Filmed on location (tour map):
Pacific Northwest: Bellingham, WA; Semiahmoo, Blaine, WA; Stanwood, WA; Maryhill Memorial, WA; White Pass WA; Chelan WA; Plymouth WA; Mount Hood Meadows, OR; White River Snow Park, Mt. Hood, OR; Hood River, OR; Bend, OR; Three Mile Canyon, OR; **California, Nevada:** BLM, Susanville, CA; Oroville, CA; Washoe Lake, NV; Rye Patch, NV; Pine Flat Lake, CA; Lake Cahuilla La Quinta, CA; Barstow, CA; French Camp, Tom's Place, CA; **Idaho, Montana, Wyoming**: Coeur d'Alene, ID; Twin Falls ID; Murtough Lake, ID; 3 Island Crossing, ID; Scotch Pines GC, ID; Rigby, ID; Missoula MT; Billings, MT; Clark Canyon Res, MT; Rocky Point, Belle Fourche, MT; Casper WY; **Utah, Colorado, New Mexico, Arizona:** Piute Reservoir, UT; Jordanelle Reservoir, UT; Bald Mountain, UT; Bonneville Salt Flats, UT; Little Salt Lake UT; Sand Hollow, Hurricane, UT; Purgatory Resort, CO; Longmont, CO; Chatfield State Park, Littleton, CO; Grand Junction, CO; Albuquerque, NM; Bottomless Lakes, Roswell, NM; Caballo Lake, NM; Elephant Butte, NM; VLA Radio Observatory, NM; Lake Pleasant, AZ; Homolovi Ruins, AZ; Scottsdale, AZ; BLM, Tusayan AZ; BLM, Quartzsite, AZ; Potato Patch CG, Jerome, AZ; Porter Spring, Roosevelt, AZ; Apache Gold, San Carlos, AZ; Roper Lake State Park, AZ; Fool Hollow, Show Low, AZ; **Kansas, Nebraska, South Dakota:**; Wichita KS; Lake Kanopolis, KS; Wilson Lake, KS; Lewis & Clark Rec Area, Yankton, SD; Platte Creek Rec Area, SD; Badlands National Park, SD; Lake Mcconaughy NE; **Oklahoma, Texas:** Oklahoma City, OK; Bear Creek Cove, OK; Lake Texoma, OK/TX; Tulsa, OK; Lawton, OK; Wichita Falls, TX; Lake Lavon, TX; Littlefield, TX; Van Horn, TX; Palmetto S.P., TX; League City, TX; Yegua Creek, Somerville, TX; Waco, TX; Lake Whitney, TX; Canyon Lake, TX; Clear Lake, Princeton, TX; Cedar Hill State Park, TX;

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*The desire to understand ourselves, to unravel the mystery of **WIDWID**—Why I Do What I Do—connects us all. It's a question I have pursued by cycling across America on three inspiring Journeys with a Purpose.*

*After decades of mishaps and 50,000 miles dragging an Airstream I no longer view **Know Thyself** as a luxury or a full-out competition with AI. With a team of like-minded thinkers (a self-defined minyan) empowered by a super-reasoning engine, I am becoming a thought leader and a sage celebrating the later execution phases of my Personal Everest with the help of a digital Sherpa.*

***Remember your first journey?** I was hopeful yet unprepared, like a Fiat 500 strapped with a useless burden on my back. At first, this image represented my idealistic youthful exploration, a journey both underpowered and naive. Recently, I discovered a double meaning in the word 'Fiat' itself. Beyond the name of a car, it refers to a decree, an authoritative commandment. In my journey, these were the self-imposed life commandments from false conclusions I formed of misspoken judgments that had shaped my worldview. It was as if the very mascot of my exploration challenged me to escape the self-tyranny of my thinking. W.H. Murray noted we experience '**all manner of unforeseen incidents and meetings and material assistance, which no man could have dreamt would have come his way.**' The discovery of the Fiat's symbolic richness was one such unforeseen incident that deepened my journey.*

Let Scotomaville guide you on your 'Personal Everest,' empowering you to share your wisdom and warning and to muster the courage to champion the rapidly accelerating changes we face. Join me by turning the life you inherited into the outcomes you design.

April 27, 2024



AUTHORS + ABSTRACT



AUTHORS CURATORS

Daniel believes; ***"The Greatest Expedition you will ever undertake is the journey to self-understanding, for the real voyage of discovery consists not in seeking new lands, but in seeing with new eyes."*** *He is a respected husband, father, entrepreneur, and Navy Veteran. He's demonstrated decades of sacrificial commitment to human achievement using core principles, perseverance, and resourcefulness.*

Angelina is the wife of a highly functioning Asperger (me) and co-founder with me of Intelligent Netware. She is twice awarded by the U.S. S.B.A. In 2004, she sustained a TBI five days before filming for the Apprentice III. Angelina is the Founder of Wellness by Choice and a mom with a mission - bent on educating and empowering the masses on how to live smarter and healthier.

SCOTOMAVILLE ABSTRACT

- ***BACKGROUND - WWDWWD***

Most people respond to chaos and stress with coping mechanisms, amygdala hijackings, and reactive behavior. For some of us, curiosity dominates. We want to know ***"Why We Do What We Do."*** *and are committed to exploring the unknown... to 'Know Thyself'. The Author cycled across America three times asking this.*

The pandemic has challenged us with hardships, losses, setbacks, missed opportunities, and personal drama. [1] Americans are weary of rapidly accelerating change.

We are flooded with messaging that games our biological and psychological bents [2]. Emotions easily overwhelm our reasoning to control our actions. We're further conflicted by being 100% wrong 50% of the time. [3] [4]

We're hoodwinked and bamboozled by tech, media, and popular narratives using trickery, flattery, and omission. [5] The adage to 'Know Thyself' is no longer a luxury. It's become a full-out competition with supercomputers pointed at our brains. [6]

■ *METHODS - IMPARTATION*

The Scotomaville program deploys the unique IMPARTATION METHODOLOGY, designed to guide participants in self-reflection and personal growth through video modeling. This methodology unfolds in a structured manner:

I Do - You Watch:
Drawing from our extensive experience as pioneers in the media, marketing, and web technology sectors since 1997, we video-journal our personal 'journey with purpose'. Through these recordings, we share and demonstrate 15 invaluable mental tools, tests, and insights that enable resilience in facing challenges. Participants, armed with just a smartphone, can emulate our perseverance as we navigate adversities such as Traumatic Brain Injury, PTSD, and more.

We Do - We Watch:
The program is more than just watching; it's engaging. Fifty-three episodes are complemented by a comprehensive 400+ page guide, enriched with opportunities for online discussions. Subscribers benefit from peer support, mentoring, and personalized guidance. Furthermore, the extensive digital reach, spanning over 4500 affiliated websites, allows for participant and sponsor recognition.

You Do - I Watch:
The Scotomaville journey doesn't end with passive learning. Upcoming offerings include transformative base camp summits, private retreats, and expeditions for leaders. With the program's licensed platform, certified leaders can guide individuals and groups, encouraging them to tread the transformative path we demonstrate.

■ *FINDINGS - SELF-GAMING*

By climbing a 'Personal Everest' and testing for oneself, the claims of W.H. Murray, and the Authors that Expeditions are filled with ***"unforeseen incidents and meetings and material assistance, which no one could have dreamt would have come their way"*** *(9) you can develop clarity, stability, healing, and successes by gaming your biases.*

Self-mastery begins with awareness of one's physical and mental self. When combined with understanding, support, and discipline, incremental character change transforms one's beliefs, attitudes, and behavior.

SCOTOMAVILLE reveals the intricate interdependence between our gut and brain, demonstrating how sleep patterns and stress levels influence our choices. By emphasizing the perils of tackling challenges solo and showcasing actionable insights and examples, the program empowers individuals to recognize and navigate their inherent cognitive biases.

■ *CONCLUSION - PERSONAL EVEREST*

A 'Personal Everest' is a journey with a purpose. ***"But at least learn your inability... and ask the remedy for it. Learn of those who have been bound like you... These are people who know the way which you would follow, and who are cured of an ill of which you would be cured. Follow the way by which they began..."***

Blaise Pascal - Pascals Wager (10)

A Personal Everest is a journey with a purpose. It is a self-defined expedition of personal development, with support and guidance from peers and the Author, and analysis by AI.

SCOTOMAVILLE is an unconventional and effective self-help model and platform with a convincing challenge: We can change our life experiences by gaming our own handicaps, strengthening alliances, challenging our shortcomings and changing our false beliefs by taking on our Personal Everest.

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(1) https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/33711676/

(2) https://www.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/pmc/articles/PMC8402266/

(3) https://www.ted.com/talks/kathryn_schulz_on_being_wrong/transcript

(4) https://www.amazon.co.uk/Yossi-Yassour/e/B08XJNFCNK/

(5) https://www.humanetech.com/who-we-are#team

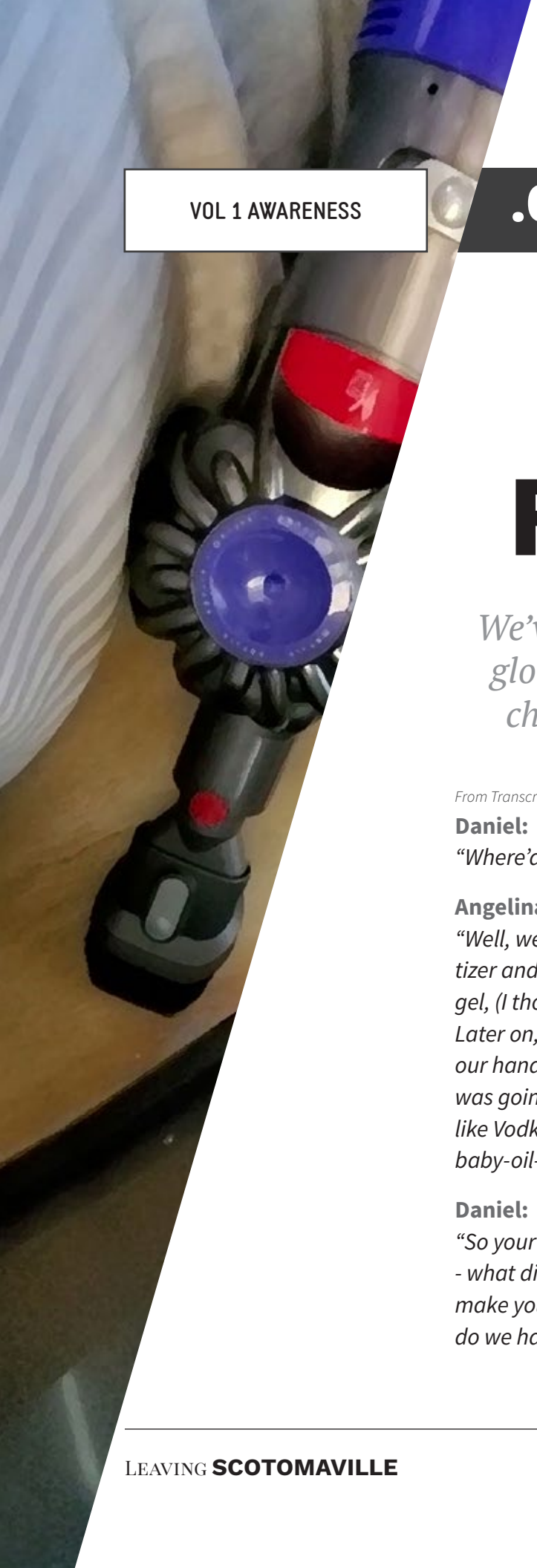
(6) https://www.wired.com/video/watch/yuval-harari-tristan-harris-humans-get-hacked

(7) https://intelligentnetware.com

(8) https://scotomaville.com/digital-locations

(9) https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/W._H._Murray

(10) https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Pascal%27s_wager



.08

FIX'N FIXATION

We've imagined microscopic killers and global supply chains. It's possible the chronic stress will have been worse.

From Transcript:

Daniel:
"Where'd the sanitizer go?

Angelina:
"Well, we had a bottle of sanitizer and I got some aloe vera gel, (I thought) at the store. Later on, when I mixed it into our hand sanitizer, and then I was going to add more alcohol, like Vodka, I realized it was baby-oil-gel."

Daniel:
"So your at-home chemistry - what did they tell you, don't make your own gels? So what do we have?"

Angelina:
"We have baby wipes."

Daniel:
"Which are not sanitizing."

Angelina:
"No, but you can wash your hands with soap and water when we get back."

Daniel:
"You're kidding, right?" Drive all the way back before I wash my hands? My nose itches. This is annoying!

"WE NEED A WALL BETWEEN ATTENTION AND FIXATION... LET'S CALL IT AWARENESS"

We're living through a turbulent time in history. Yet, we have the opportunity to become more self-aware than any preceding generation. I recorded this the first week in April 2020. We were all experiencing one of the most challenging things of a generation. Looking back, you recall facing things like mandates.

Being forced to consider the world from a different point of view was a fabulous opportunity to change our trajectory.

Let's make the distinction between fixating and simply paying attention. And because we're traveling in an Airstream, I'm going to use tools called transparency and authenticity.

For the second edition, I used Grammarly. For the third, I have AI. The events were not scripted. I shared as stuff happened, to prove my thesis points.

"This may sound too simple, but is great in consequence."
- W. H. Murray

I believe the difference between fixation and attention is the attached emotional baggage.

I am NOT a scientist, scholar or physician. I am an explorer, and student that has followed others.

We remember things, as I see it, using billions of neuronal connections forming millions of electrical pathways. Our memories are partial recordings of what we might have heard, seen and felt, and care to recall.

Diffuse vs. Focused Mode:

I took a fabulous class called 'Learning How To Learn' taught by a Neuroscientist, and a Ph.D. in Systems Engineering.

The class discusses two different facets of thinking. One is ***diffuse****, like a cloud of ideas or a swirling bucket of memories thrown into the wind. Diffuse thinking is broad pattern thinking that happens when you consider ideas, as with daydreaming.*

The other type of thinking is ***focused mode****. It's what happens when we study or when we're writing code, or we're solving a problem. When we're thinking intensely, soaking in what's happening right in front of us we are focused, and often fixated.*

The point is to cycle between the two modes, and not to fixate on either one alone.

After we've focused for roughly 40 minutes, it's time to have some diffuse thinking to process new ideas that are related to established beliefs, choosing which to keep and which to forget.



Angelina is thinking diffused and 'in a zone' – as opposed to focused thinking on accounting

Angelina is having diffuse time on a donkey trail, flushing my fixation on the sanitizer challenge.



For this Third Edition, I want to engage the reader, aligning with the video transcript, while drawing out stronger evidence.

Certainly, Daniel. Here's a restructured version that integrates the transcript and the referenced insights from the minyan, presenting a holistic understanding.

Introduction: The Power of Mind

Albert Einstein once said, "The world as we have created it is a process of our thinking."

"Transcript: When we repeatedly recall thoughts and memories, we form neurological circuits. The electrical pathways become embedded metaphorically. They become insulated, like a rubber-coated wire."

1. Neurological Circuits: Habit Formation

In the words of Carl Rogers, "The only person who is educated is the one who has learned how to learn ...and change."

"That's how habits begin. The electrical routes become frequented and established."

2. Formation of Beliefs: Focus and Diffuse Mode

As Viktor Frankl emphasized, "Between stimulus and response, there is a space... In that space is our power to choose our response."

"The information we gather in focus mode is associated with diverse ideas in diffuse mode, and the combination becomes



THERE ARE ALWAYS 'BIG MESSES' IN A TINY LIVING SPACE BUT WE TEND...



...TO 'FIXATE' ON THE TINY SCREW HOLES AND FINGER-PRINTS

our beliefs. Beliefs underly our attitudes about things like masks, mandates, inflation, and obedience."

3. Emotional Reactions: Triggers and Instincts

"Know thyself," *Socrates urged.*

"When we recall things, our emotional 'black boxes' trigger feelings, and our protective instincts quickly react. We take shortcuts on well used pathways that end in familiar but incorrect feelings, like your wife stalking you as a hungry tiger fixates on a warm meal."

4. Fixation vs Attention:

Jim Rohn, often said, "Wherever you are, be there."

"So let's look at some examples around the Airstream to differentiate the line between fixation and attention. The full-time Airstream experience is - it's hard to describe - I mean, you can see the constant mess."

5. Self-Understanding: Emotional Exploration

Marcus Aurelius wisely noted, "The happiness of your life depends upon the quality of your thoughts."

"I'm at the laundromat, sitting in the truck waiting for a load inside to dry. I start peeling: Why did I get triggered this morning? (awareness) Because I didn't want to go to the laundromat. (excuse) I wanted to hand wash the few clothes we had. (defense) Why do I have so few clothes? Ahhh, there's an emotionally rich answer welling up!"

6. Peeling the Onion Exercise: Inner Discovery

C.S. Lewis wrote, "You are never too old to set another goal or to dream a new dream."

"Do you see me peeling an onion? My mom sewed most of my clothes or bought them at Sears. So I didn't get bell-bottoms and tie-dye - I got geek clothing. (a memory) I'm frustrated that I have to go to a laundromat and potentially expose myself to the corona-virus because I have but five underwear. Just buy more, Daniel. They are not scarce.

I solved the underwear challenge, and I exposed a strong emotion and memory supporting a faulty conclusion from long before - 'I'm not the kind of kid that gets new clothing.'"

7. Over-Activated Attention and Personal Growth

Zig Ziglar stated, "You don't have to be great to start, but you have to start to be great."

"Fixation is over-attention. Life is like this. We can't rely on everything going as we want. We have to summit our Personal Everest, expecting that "life is what happens between our plans," and when we are ready to grow - all kinds of events will unfold that offer greater revelation of our false beliefs."

Conclusion: Journey to Self-Understanding

As you yourself have eloquently put it: "The greatest expedition you will ever undertake is the journey to self-understanding."

Back to Transcript:

"So, you won't have arrived, but you'll be LEAVING Scotomaville on your journey.

(recording an affirmation on my phone)

Daniel. You're not mad at Angelina; you're frustrated, with emotions in tension between imagined tigers, scarcity and humiliation. Remember, mom was a teen on the streets. She didn't understand your needs."

This combination of your personal examples with insights from the minyan creates a richer narrative that connects with readers and enhances understanding. Feel free to guide changes as needed!

Hey reader, I appreciate you! You're going to make it! You're going to do just fine!

"when the student is ready, the teacher will appear"

Elephant Fixation and Focused Mode Thinking

The parable of "The Blind Men and the Elephant" has rich and varied origins, making it familiar to many cultures and philosophical traditions. Its universal themes of humility, empathy, and the pursuit of a more comprehensive understanding resonate across various philosophical, religious, and cultural contexts.

This parable highlights the limitations of fixation and intense focus on one aspect of a complex reality. ***While each man's focused observation was correct in a narrow sense, their inability to integrate different perspectives led to misunderstanding and conflict.***

The lesson from this story aligns with your philosophy of self-understanding, awareness of our blind spots, and the search for broader wisdom. ***It serves as a reminder to step back from intense fixation on specific details and to strive for a more holistic understanding of our experiences and the world around us.***

This parable also resonates with the words of Marcus Aurelius, who emphasized the importance of seeing things in their entirety:

"Always look at things as parts of a whole, and remember that no part can exist without a coordinating whole."



The Blind Men and the Elephant

In this story, six blind men were asked to describe an elephant by touching different parts of the animal. Each man became fixated on the part he was touching, unable to see the whole.

The first man, touching the elephant's trunk, insisted it was like a snake.

The second man, feeling the elephant's ear, argued that it was like a fan.

The third man, holding the elephant's tusk, claimed it was like a spear.

The others, touching different parts of the elephant, described it as a wall, a tree, or a rope.

Each man was in a state of focused mode thinking, concentrated only on the part he was touching. While each man's observation was correct in a narrow sense, fixation on their individual experiences led to a fragmented and incomplete understanding of the elephant - all of them blind to the aerial drone above, or the intention of the pilot, or the aim of the intelligence commanding it.

Psychological fixation means *having attachments to people or focusing on things that persist from childhood to adulthood. Fixation is when the attention required to 'fix' something is focused on an idea, impulse, or aim, especially an obsessive preoccupation with something...*

Your turn. List some fixations.

WATCH

https://youtu.be/SGKabABiH28

REFLECT

https://youtu.be/qALNBefGNSQ

DISCUSS

Consider the dynamics of questioning your impulses, commitments, and attention. Awareness can reveal false conclusions or become a fixation.

Scan the code to discuss fixation with other explorers and me.



Myelinated sheaths *are insulating layers made up of myelin, a fatty substance that surrounds the axons of many nerve cells. The primary function of the myelin sheath is to increase the speed of electrical impulses along the neurons, enhancing communication between different parts of the nervous system.*

Diffuse mode *refers to a mental state where the brain is relaxed and able to make broad, abstract connections. It's often linked with creativity and insights, occurring when we're engaging in activities that don't require intense focus, like taking a walk or daydreaming.*

Focus mode, *in contrast to diffuse mode, represents a mental state where the mind is highly concentrated on a particular task or problem. It is associated with logical thinking, analytical processing, and attention to detail. Focus mode is necessary for deep learning, problem-solving, and mastery of complex subjects.*

These terms interplay to create a dynamic learning process. The myelinated sheath enables efficient neural communication, which facilitates both focused and diffuse modes of thinking. The balance between focus and diffuse modes is essential for fostering creativity and problem-solving, resonating with the journey to self-understanding and self-mastery that you emphasize in your teachings.

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